



FIFA 23

EA BOWS OUT WITH A GAME FOR THE FANS

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Fifa 23 is finally here. As a long-term fan of the franchise, it's a bitter-sweet moment for me to review the last installment of what's arguably the world's most popular football simulator. With Fifa 23, a three-decade-long partnership that started in 1993 finally comes to an end. EA has already announced plans of launching a new game under the banner of EA Sports FC starting next year.

But that hasn't stopped the publisher from completely surprising me with this one. After years of dishing out the same old experience, Fifa 23 feels like a big step forward for the franchise. Not only does it feel closer to being a football simulator than before, it feels like a well-built game, based on a code that's not a simple variation of what was used to build last year's game.

WHAT'S NEW?

Even in terms of feature updates,

Fifa '23 is also one of the best we've seen over the last few generations. We get women's club football teams for the first time, and later this year, it will also get an update that will bring the squads and a tournament mode for the men's world cup.

Then there are updates to VOLTA, Pro Clubs, Career Mode, and last but not the least, we also get some much-needed changes to the Ultimate Team, with the team chemistry system that builds the base of the franchise's money-making mode now being completely overhauled. However, even this system is biased heavily towards the idea of using the game's best players and finding a way of putting them in a team -- something that we would have loved to have seen change with this game.

And did we mention that we finally get online cross-play? Yes, now EA allows the matching of games between consoles, and now those on PC are also able to play against PS5 and Xbox Series X players in seasons and friendlies, significantly cutting down those long wait times for finding matches while playing online.

But in our opinion, the biggest changes that have been introduced with Fifa 23 are not in the features department. Rather, it's in the game mechanics.

GAMEPLAY AND MECHANICS

The game feels more fluid than ever, with off-the-ball movements feeling very natural. And when you're on the ball, we noticed a lot more to like. This is where FIFA 23's new Hypermotion 2 technology kicks in, bringing with it improved ball physics and new animations, which again gives FIFA 23 a more realistic feel, simulator feel. The improved physics also makes the game more unpredictable,